

Remember to restart CDBurnerXP if you want to burn an audio CD. It's a bit annoying, but there you go

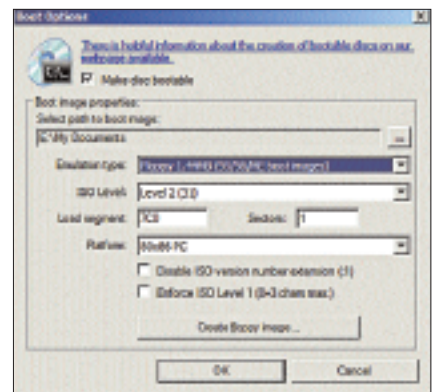
Burning Audio CDs

If you're burning data CDs all the time and you want to burn an Audio CD, you'll notice no option to create a new Audio CD—the only way is to close CDBurnerXP and restart it; only this time, make sure you choose the Create Audio CD button. Now you can drag and drop audio files like you would data files.

If you want to burn an audio CD without spaces between tracks, use the dropdown menu for Burn disc with DAO when in Audio CD burning mode.

Creating A Bootable Disc

Creating bootable discs may be needed while trying to create LiveCDs or booting into them for OS installations. Go to Disc > Boot options and mark the checkbox against Make Disc Bootable. Click the button to select the image and choose the type of emulation from the dropdown menu. You can also



Embedding a boot image onto a disc is simple to do

create an image from a floppy drive by clicking on Create Floppy Drive.

Working With Disc Images

CDBurnerXP has features that allow you to create or burn disc images. If you have images that were created on Nero, for example, you can convert them to ISO by going to File > Convert ISO Image. Select the source file—which can be either a BIN or an NRG file—and then select a location to create the image in. Click the Convert to ISO button.

Discs can be replicated in the same manner. If you don't want to burn them right away, you can have the image created from the disc dumped on the hard drive. Go to File > Copy ISO disc. Select the source drive and instead of the destination drive being the optical disc drive, select the hard drive. Now a new field will appear. Here you can choose the path and a name for the ISO to be dumped.

NERO 8

Nero isn't just about the Burning ROM software—it's also about all the extras that come with it. You can find the installer for the trial version of Nero 8 on the November DVD.

Move The Cache Folder

Nero uses a location on the hard drive when it needs to cache files before burning them. If you're running short on space in your main partition, you would want to change it to one with more free space. Go to File > Options > Cache and click on Browse to choose a new location.

Sounds For Events

Nero has support for sounds but they are disabled by default. Go to File > Options > Sounds tab to set sounds for events. The sounds that come with Nero are in the default locations, but you can select the ones you want by clicking the Browse button.

Nero BurnRights

Nero BurnRights is an application that comes with Nero; it allows you to define which users on your system can burn CDs and DVDs. Go to Start > All Programs > Nero 8 > Nero Toolkit > Nero BurnRights. Select the type of users that you want to give permission to and click OK.

Do Not Eject The Drive

Every CD burnt is immediately ejected from the drive by default in Nero. To keep the CD or DVD in the drive once it's done, go to File > Options > Expert Features. Check the box against Do not eject the disc after the burn is complete and click OK.

Retro Nero

We all miss the Nero Burning ROM from the past years when it was a compact little CD / DVD burning software and not a complete suite with modules we never use. It's reached a point where there are tiny, hacked, illegal releases of Nero Burning ROM

made available on the Internet which take a fraction of the space of the entire suite. If you have the nasty habit of blindly clicking "Next" during the Nero 8 installation, you'll most probably have skipped the screen where you choose the Custom installation mode. Uninstall your current copy of Nero if you have it installed. Start the installation till you reach the window where you can choose between Typical and Custom installation. Select the Custom install option and click Next. You'll soon see a window with the list of all the Nero components selected. Click on each one of them and select This Feature Will Not Be Available. Do the same for everything other than Nero Burning ROM and continue with

Easter Egg!

Nero Burning ROM still has the Easter Egg which you can find in most of its earlier versions. Go to Help > About to see the credits. Double-click in this window and you'll see the credits text flowing with different kind of effects. If you hold down [Ctrl] and [Shift] together and then double-click, the effects and scrolling will speed up.

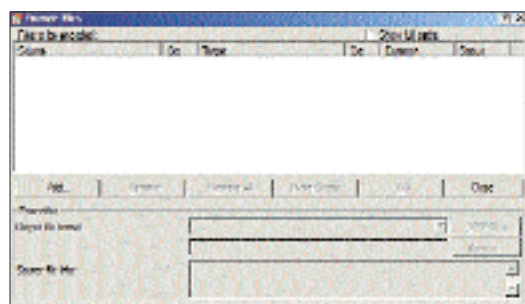
the installation. At the end, you'll have completed your own clean compact Nero Burning ROM installation the way it used to be.

Searching For Specific Formats

Trying to search for a few selected filetypes you need to burn can be a nightmare in an unsorted folder. To look for a particular file using wildcards, right-click on the folder in the left pane of the browser window. Click on Select pattern. Enter wildcards with semicolons as separators and click OK. For example, entering *Digit*;*.PDF as the pattern will select all files with "Digit" in their names and PDFs as well.

Encode Audio Files

Nero Burning ROM comes with an in-built audio encoder: go to Extras > Encode Files, click on Add and



A basic audio encoder is built into Nero Burning ROM

select the files you want to encode. Using the drop-down menu for Output file format, select which format you want to encode to and click on the Settings button to set parameters for the encoder. Finally, click on the Browse button to select where you want to store the encoded files once encoded. Click Go to start encoding!

Better Compatibility

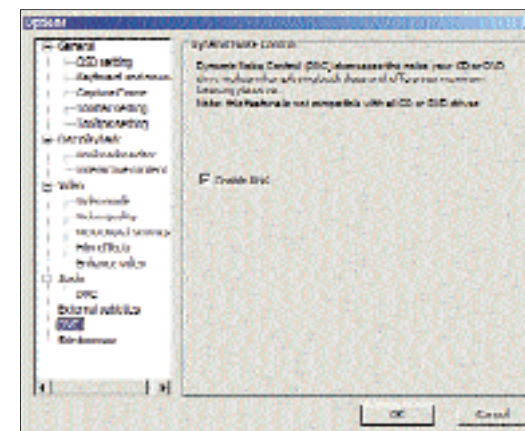
One of the issues with media and the way they are burned is that is that they're not always compatible on all DVD players. There are a few things that can be done to solve this: one of them is to set the high-compatibility mode on for your drive. Click on the Choose Recorder button to the right of the drop-down menu for selecting the drive. Select your drive and click on Options. Check the box against DVD High Compatibility Mode. This will make sure that at least a gigabyte of data is written on the media even if you don't have that much data.

Another thing you can do is to use the Book Type settings—this is basically is to tell the drive that you have inserted a DVD-ROM (for example) not a DVD-RW or any other kind of DVD. This way, there are better chances of the drive reading your media. Use the drop-down menu for Book Type settings in the drive properties window and select DVD-ROM, as it generally gives better compatibility.

NERO SHOWTIME

Dynamic Noise Control

If you're playing CDs or DVDs, you would know that your drives run continuously like your hard drives do. The noise from spinning up and down of the drives can be distracting. Nero's developers have implemented a feature called dynamic noise control that helps reduce this sound. You can find this option by right clicking on the Nero

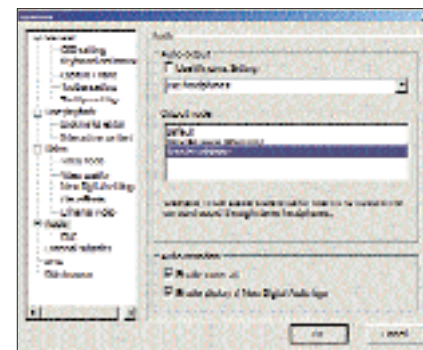


Dynamic Noise Control can help lower drive noise with certain drives

ShowTime interface and clicking on Options. Click on DNC. Turn it on if it's off.

Dynamic Range Control

Dynamic Range Control is not just another fancy name for a feature in Nero ShowTime. It is basically normalisation of the volume of the audio stream—so if you're listening to music files of different volume levels, you won't have to jump to the PC every time a loud file plays. Right-click on the ShowTime interface, select Options and go to Audio > DRC.



Watching movies with surround sound on headphones is worth trying

(Pseudo) Surround Sound On Headphones!

Nero ShowTime is great for watching high-definition videos, and with these, you're bound to get multi-channel audio as well. Now not all of us have fancy surround sound speaker setups. Nero can simulate surround sound and give satisfactory results on stereo speakers and headphones as well! Right-click on the ShowTime interface and select Options. Under Audio, uncheck the box for Use Windows Settings. From the dropdown, select the type of setup you have—if you select 2 speakers, use Nero Virtual Speaker from the Output mode. If you have headphones, check Nero Headphone.

Customise Fonts

Nero uses an On-screen Display (OSD) to display information of the video or movie being played. By default, a set of fonts and colours are assigned to it, but you can select a better set of fonts and colours if you wish. Go to Options and click on OSD Settings under General. Make sure Enable is checked, and then click on Set Font to change the font type for the OSD. In the previous menu, you will also find the option for setting a colour and a

position where you want the OSD to show up.

Similar fonts are used to display subtitles for movies. There, too, you can set which fonts should be used to display them. In the Options window, click on External Subtitles; check the box against Enable External Subtitles and click the Set Font button to set a different font style.

Video Quality

High-definition playback isn't very easy for all hardware unless there's hardware decoding support from your graphics card or if you have a fairly new dual-core processor. Nero has an automatic quality setting that downsizes the quality of the video if your system doesn't perform too well. You can find this option under Video Quality under Options > Video. The setting should be set to Auto-adjust. If you know your system performs fine, then you would want the best quality—push the slider to Maximum Quality and vice versa if your system isn't performing as well as you'd like.

Nero's Image Mounting tool

Nero comes with software called ImageDrive which you'll find under Nero Toolkit in the Start Menu. It allows you to mount .NRG and .ISO images as a virtual drives so you can load some of your backed-up discs without having to put them in the drive. When you first run it, it installs the drivers which create a virtual drive. Once that's done, click on the Enable drive checkbox for the first drive. If you want a second drive, you can check that box as well. A new tab called First Drive will appear. Click on it and point to the image you want to mount. Now when you go to My Computer or Explorer, you will find a new drive in the list. Clicking on it will reveal all the files and folders from the image.

Nero DiscSpeed

DVDs have had a comparatively notorious reputation when it comes to reliability, so it's very important to use good media and check the data on it. Nero DiscSpeed, under Nero Toolkit, allows you to check for disc quality. Select the Disc Quality tab and insert a burnt disc into the drive. Make sure you have the DVD drive selected from the drop-down menu at the top and click Start. The software gauges the quality of the burnt disc. A final score will be shown in the Quality score field on the right. On Internet forums, you'll find a lot of such media scan posts. Run this test on different kinds of media you've burnt so you know which media works best with your drive.